Activity 2

Moon or Cloud?

Observe the moon on a windy night with a fair bit of cloud cover in the sky. As the cloud passes in front of the moon you sometimes think it is the moon which is moving behind the cloud. What would you think if you were to observe a tree at the same time?





Aryabatta, an ancient Indian astronomer, said, "As the banks of the river appear to move back to a person in a boat floating gently in a river, the night sky studded with stars appear to move from the east to the west and so the Earth rotates from the west to the east."



How things move?

When we kick a ball it moves. When we push the book on the table, it moves. When a bullock pulls, the cart moves. Motion occurs when an object is pulled or pushed by an agency.



In our daily life, we pull out water from the well using bucket. Animals pull a bullock cart. It is a person or animal, that is an animate agency that does the pushing or pulling.

Sometimes we see a tall grass in the meadow dancing in the wind or a piece of wood moving down a stream. What pushes or pulls them? We know that blowing wind and flowing water is the cause. Sometimes the push or pull can be due to the inanimate agency.

Forces are push or pull by an animate or inanimate agency.

Contact, Non-contact Forces

Forces can be classified into two major types; contact and non-contact forces.